

Baha Khammari

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Research Interests

Applied microeconomics, causal inference, labour economics, policy evaluation, development economics.
Methodological focus on difference-in-differences estimation, panel data methods, and heterogeneous treatment effects.

Education

University of Cologne Cologne, Germany
M.Sc. Economics (expected Sep. 2026, current GPA: 1.6/1.0) *Oct. 2023 – Sep. 2026*

- Specialisation: Applied Econometrics, Energy Economics, Financial Macroeconomics.
- Relevant coursework: Advanced Econometrics, Causal Inference, Panel Data Analysis, Time Series Econometrics, Microeconomics, Energy Economics.
- 6 ECTS remaining (one seminar paper), available from Oct. 2026.

Rotterdam School of Management (RSM), Erasmus University Rotterdam, Netherlands
Erasmus+ Exchange Semester *Sep. 2024 – Dec. 2024*

- Coursework in Asset Pricing (CAPM, multi-factor models) and Derivatives Valuation (Black–Scholes, option strategies).

University of Cologne Cologne, Germany
B.Sc. Economics (Grade: 1.6/1.0, top 5 % of cohort, Dean's List) *Oct. 2019 – Feb. 2023*

Research Experience

Master's Thesis University of Cologne
Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Pia Pinger & Anna Person (PhD candidate) | Grade: 1.0/1.0 *Oct. 2025 – Apr. 2026*

- **Title:** *How Equal is Equal Opportunity? Gender, Ethnic and Regional Disparities in Labor Market Outcomes of Higher Education Policies in Brazil.*
- Estimated the causal labour-market effects of Brazil's ProUni scholarship programme on 558 microregions (2005–2019) using the Callaway & Sant'Anna (2021) heterogeneity-robust staggered DiD estimator with doubly-robust inference.
- Constructed a microregion-level panel linking ProUni administrative records, RAIS formal employer–employee data (~5 million observations), and Census demographics via the `basedosdados` BigQuery interface.
- Documented a non-monotonic dose–response: +3.04 % wage effect in Low-Dose regions (DR estimate, $p < 0.10$), negative Mid-Dose effects coinciding with recession timing, and near-zero High-Dose effects consistent with diminishing returns.
- Showed that naïve TWFE masks positive low-dose effects ($\hat{\beta}_{\text{TWFE}} = -0.65\%$), providing an empirical illustration of forbidden comparisons (Goodman-Bacon, 2021).
- Heterogeneity analysis: wage gains accrue disproportionately to non-white workers in moderate-exposure markets (consistent with affirmative-action design). Gender asymmetry persists despite majority-female scholarship uptake.
- Robustness: HonestDiD sensitivity analysis (Rambachan & Roth, 2023), age-cohort placebo, Bacon decomposition, alternative dose cutoffs, concurrent-policy controls (FIES, Quota Law).
- Tools: R (`did`, `fixest`, `HonestDiD`, `tidyverse`, `ggplot2`), SQL/BigQuery, $\text{\LaTeX}$.

Seminar Paper: Housing and the Macroeconomy University of Cologne
Instructor: Prof. Dr. Michael Krause *2024*

- Analysed the role of subprime mortgage credit expansion in the U.S. financial crisis, drawing on the Mian & Sufi empirical framework linking household leverage to employment and consumption declines.

- **Title:** *The Financial Accelerator Mechanism.*
- Reviewed and synthesised the theoretical literature on financial frictions and macroeconomic amplification, with a focus on the Bernanke–Gertler–Gilchrist (1999) framework.

Technical Skills

- **Programming & Data Analysis:** R (advanced: `did`, `fixest`, `HonestDiD`, `tidyverse`, `ggplot2`), Python (basic), SQL/BigQuery.
- **Econometric Methods:** Difference-in-Differences (incl. staggered adoption, doubly-robust estimation), Instrumental Variables, Panel Data Models, Event Studies, Bacon Decomposition.
- **Tools:** L^AT_EX/Overleaf, Git/GitHub, MS Excel (advanced, VBA), Power BI.

Professional Experience

PwC Germany

Düsseldorf, Germany

Intern & Working Student – Assurance Solutions

Mar. 2023 – Jul. 2025

- Conducted variance analyses and plausibility checks for annual and group audits (HGB/IFRS) of clients with balance sheets exceeding EUR 500 million.
- Audited sustainability disclosures under ISAE 3000 and performed internal control system (IKS) testing.
- Developed Excel-based tools (VBA) for KPI tracking and financial forecasting.

Languages

- German (native), Tunisian Arabic (native), English (C1, IELTS Academic 8.0), French (B1, DELF).

Awards & Activities

- **Dean's List**, University of Cologne. Top 5 % of B.Sc. Economics cohort.
- **2nd Prize**, Young Economic Summit (YES!) 2018, national finals. Developed a policy solution on digital trust in online transactions. Organised by ZBW Leibniz Information Centre for Economics under patronage of the Federal Ministry for Economic Affairs.
- **DPG Abitur Prize**, Deutsche Physikalische Gesellschaft (2019), awarded for outstanding performance in Physics.

References

- Available upon request.